



BA Integrated Development Studies (IDS) – UDS Programme Structure (2008/2009 Academic Year Reconstruction)

University Background

The **University for Development Studies (UDS)** introduced optional pathways within the Bachelor of Arts in Integrated Development Studies programme during the 2008/2009 academic year. Before this period, students in the Faculty of Integrated Development Studies (FIDS) generally graduated with a single BA Integrated Development Studies degree without specialization.

Historical sources indicate that the 2008/2009 academic year marked the transition into option-based IDS programmes. The first batch of students under the revised structure graduated in 2010.

Evidence from Historical Sources

The following programme options were introduced around the 2008/2009 academic year:

1. Environment and Resources Management

2. Economics and Entrepreneurship Development
3. Development Communication
4. Development Administration

Sources also confirm that the programme maintained UDS' interdisciplinary philosophy, integrating development theory, economics, sociology, governance, communication, environmental studies, and community-based fieldwork.

Reconstructed Programme Structure Based on the Five-Department FIDS System

The BA Integrated Development Studies (IDS) programme under the Faculty of Integrated Development Studies (FIDS) at the Wa Campus of the **University for Development Studies**", operated through five major academic departments around the 2008/2009 academic period.

These departments jointly delivered the IDS curriculum using UDS' interdisciplinary development philosophy.

The Five Departments

1. Department of Economics & Entrepreneurship Development
2. Department of Environmental & Resource Studies
3. Department of Social, Political & Historical Studies
4. Department of Planning, Land Economy & Rural Development (DPLERD)
5. Department of Communication Studies

The curriculum structure below reconstructs how courses were likely distributed across the departments during the 2008/2009 academic year.

YEAR 1 – GENERAL FOUNDATION COURSES

During the first year, all IDS students generally studied common interdisciplinary foundation courses drawn from all five departments.

Semester 1

Department of Social, Political & Historical Studies

- Introduction to Sociology
- African Studies
- Principles of Political Science
- Ghanaian Social History

Department of Economics & Entrepreneurship Development

- Principles of Economics I
- Basic Accounting

Department of Communication Studies

- Communication Skills I
- Study Skills and Academic Writing

General University Courses

- Basic Statistics
 - Computer Literacy
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Semester 2

Department of Social, Political & Historical Studies

- Introduction to Development Studies
- Rural Sociology
- Ghana Government and Administration

Department of Economics & Entrepreneurship Development

- Principles of Economics II
- Entrepreneurship Studies I

Department of Environmental & Resource Studies

- Introduction to Environmental Studies
- Natural Resource Use in Ghana

Department of Communication Studies

- Communication Skills II

- Introduction to Development Communication

General Courses

- ICT Applications
 - Field Orientation
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YEAR 2 – INTERDISCIPLINARY DEVELOPMENT TRAINING

Students continued with common IDS courses while gradually developing interest areas linked to the five departments.

Semester 1

Department of Economics & Entrepreneurship Development

- Development Economics
- Entrepreneurship Development
- Agricultural Economics

Department of Environmental & Resource Studies

- Environmental Management
- Sustainable Resource Utilization

Department of Social, Political & Historical Studies

- Social Policy and Development
- Population and Development
- Gender and Development

Department of Planning, Land Economy & Rural Development

- Introduction to Planning
- Rural Development Theory
- Community Development

Department of Communication Studies

- Communication for Development

- Media and Society

Research Component

- Social Research Methods I
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Semester 2

Department of Planning, Land Economy & Rural Development

- Development Planning
- Land Economy
- Participatory Rural Appraisal
- Project Planning and Management

Department of Social, Political & Historical Studies

- Decentralization and Local Governance
- NGOs and Development

Department of Economics & Entrepreneurship Development

- Small Enterprise Management
- Quantitative Techniques

Department of Communication Studies

- Public Relations for Development
- Community Information Systems

Research Component

- Social Research Methods II
 - Monitoring and Evaluation
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THIRD TRIMESTER FIELD PRACTICAL PROGRAMME (TTFPP)

A major component of the IDS programme was the:

Third Trimester Field Practical Programme (TTFPP)

Students were attached to rural communities during the third trimester to undertake practical development work.

Activities Included

- Community entry and engagement
- Participatory Rural Appraisal (PRA)
- Household surveys
- Data collection and analysis
- Community needs assessment
- Rural livelihood studies
- Development planning exercises
- Community report writing
- Group presentations

Objectives of TTFPP

- Integrate theory with practice
- Expose students to real development challenges
- Promote participatory development approaches
- Build research and communication skills
- Encourage community-centered problem solving

The TTFPP was one of the most distinctive features of the UDS educational model.

YEAR 3 – DEPARTMENTAL SPECIALIZATION PHASE

From the third year onward, students increasingly concentrated their studies within departmental areas.

1. Department of Economics & Entrepreneurship Development

Semester 1

- Intermediate Microeconomics
- Intermediate Macroeconomics
- Development Finance
- Business Management
- Entrepreneurship and Innovation

Semester 2

- Project Appraisal
- Financial Institutions and Markets
- Poverty and Development
- Cooperative Development
- Investment Analysis

Career Orientation

This department prepared students for careers in:

- Entrepreneurship
 - Banking and finance
 - Development consultancy
 - SME development
 - NGO project management
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2. Department of Environmental & Resource Studies

Semester 1

- Natural Resource Management
- Climate and Development
- Environmental Policy
- Sustainable Agriculture
- Ecology and Society

Semester 2

- Environmental Impact Assessment

- Water Resource Management
- Forest and Wildlife Management
- Land Degradation Studies
- Sustainable Development Strategies

Career Orientation

Graduates often worked in:

- Environmental NGOs
- Forestry and agriculture sectors
- Climate projects
- Resource management institutions
- Environmental policy organizations

3. Department of Social, Political & Historical Studies

Semester 1

- Political Economy
- Governance and Development
- African Political Systems
- Social Change and Modernization
- Conflict and Peace Studies

Semester 2

- Public Policy Analysis
- Human Rights and Development
- Contemporary African Issues
- Leadership and Governance
- Comparative Political Systems

Career Orientation

This department prepared students for:

- Public administration
- Governance institutions
- Civil society organizations

- Policy analysis
 - Research and academia
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4. Department of Planning, Land Economy & Rural Development (DPLERD)

Semester 1

- Regional Planning
- Land Use Planning
- Settlement Planning
- Rural Development Planning
- Geographic Information Systems (GIS)

Semester 2

- Housing and Infrastructure Planning
- Rural Livelihood Systems
- Urbanization and Development
- Project Monitoring and Evaluation
- Community Mobilization

Career Orientation

Graduates commonly entered:

- Physical planning departments
 - District assemblies
 - Land administration
 - Rural development agencies
 - Development planning institutions
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5. Department of Communication Studies

Semester 1

- Development Communication Theory
- Media Ethics

- Communication Research
- Radio Production
- Journalism for Development

Semester 2

- Community Media Systems
- Public Advocacy Campaigns
- Strategic Communication
- Communication for Social Change
- Development Reporting

Career Orientation

Students pursued careers in:

- Journalism
- Development communication
- Public relations
- Community media
- Advocacy organizations

YEAR 4 – ADVANCED STUDIES AND RESEARCH

Semester 1

Common Advanced Courses

- Advanced Development Theory
- Research Seminar
- Programme Evaluation
- Leadership and Governance
- Development Policy Analysis

Departmental Electives

Students selected advanced electives from their departmental specialization.

Research Component

- Long Essay / Research Project I
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Semester 2

Common Courses

- Contemporary Development Issues
- International Development Cooperation
- Sustainable Development Policy

Practical Component

- Internship Report
- Community Development Presentation

Research Component

- Long Essay / Research Project II
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Integrated Nature of the IDS Programme

The BA IDS programme was unique because students combined:

- Economics
- Governance
- Planning
- Environmental studies
- Communication
- Rural development
- Community fieldwork

This interdisciplinary model distinguished UDS from many traditional Ghanaian universities during the period.

Career Prospects Around 2009

Graduates commonly worked in:

- District Assemblies
 - NGOs
 - Community development projects
 - Environmental organizations
 - Research institutions
 - Planning departments
 - Media houses
 - Government ministries
 - International development agencies
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Historical Notes

Historical sources suggest that:

- FIDS was one of the flagship faculties of the Wa Campus.
 - The IDS programme emphasized practical community engagement.
 - The TTFPP was central to the curriculum.
 - Students increasingly specialized through the five departmental structures.
 - The interdisciplinary approach was designed to train development-oriented graduates for Northern Ghana and beyond.
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Referenced Online Sources

- <https://ubids.edu.gh/fids/overview>
 - <https://ubids.edu.gh/fids/departments/development-studies/>
 - <https://legonconnect.com/uds-faculty-integrated-development-studies/>
 - <https://admissionsgh.com/uds-faculty-integrated-development-studies/>
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Important Disclaimer

This document is a reconstructed academic outline based on archived web information and historical programme descriptions from the 2008/2009 era. It should not be treated as an official UDS handbook or transcript-equivalent curriculum.

An exact official semester-by-semester course list from 2009 may only be obtainable from:

- UDS archives

- Former students/alumni
- Printed faculty handbooks
- University library records
- Archived departmental documents